

Data description

Below follows a description of the data and do-files necessary for replication of Lundqvist, Dahlberg and Mörk: “Stimulating Local Public Employment: Do General Grants Work?”

Data

There are three main data sets used:

1. **“municipaldata.dta”**: This data set includes most of the variables used in the analysis. The data source is Statistics Sweden for the total population and population share variables, and for the expenditure variable. The data source is The Swedish Association of Local Authorities and Regions (SALAR) for the personnel variables, the wage variables, the grant variable and the population change variable. As for the personnel variables, the definition of leave of absence changed in 1998, and the 1996 and 1997 values have been adjusted accordingly.
2. **“IFAU_pers.dta”**: This data set includes the two different kinds of bureaucrats, used in Section V of the paper. The data source is The Institute for Evaluation of Labour Market and Education Policy (IFAU). The original data from IFAU is in individual form and includes everyone employed by a municipality. From the original data we have used occupational codes to construct variables measuring the aggregate number of administrative assistants and high officials in a given municipality in a given year.¹
3. **“outsourced_pers.dta”**: This data set includes outsourced personnel, used in Section IV of the paper. The data source is Statistics Sweden. Outsourced personnel are defined as those working for a non-profit or for-profit private firm. The four different sectors (child care, schools, elderly care and social welfare) are defined using sector codes.²

All variables in the three main data sets are labeled (please use the “describe” command in STATA).

¹In particular, we use the so-called SSYK (“Standard for Swedish Occupational Classification”) codes, and we define administrative assistants as those with codes 247, 2470 and 4111–4120, and high administrative officials as those with codes 1210, 1221–1229, 1231–1239 and 1311–1319.

²In particular, so-called SNI (“Standard for Swedish Sector Classification”) codes are used; codes 80101 and 85322 are classified as child care; codes 80102, 80210, 80221 and 80223 are classified as schools; codes 85311, 85312, 85327 and 85328 are classified as elderly care; and codes 85313, 85315, 85316, 85323, 85324 and 85329 are classified as social welfare.

Do-files

There are four do-files:

1. **“create_data.do”**: This do-file merges the three main data sets, creates new variables used in the analysis and drops a few municipalities that, e.g., have been involved in mergers during the studied period (see footnote 18). Running this do-file results in the data set “finaldata.dta”
2. **“estimations.do”**: Using “finaldata.dta”, this do-file reproduces the results presented in the various tables in the paper.
3. **“graphics.do”**: Using “finaldata.dta”, this do-file reproduces the various graphs in the paper.
4. **“online_appendix.do”**: Using “finaldata.dta”, this do-file reproduces the results presented in the various tables in the Online Appendix.